

## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

## PART A Group Interaction

Below is a report from a market research company:

Hong Kong loves Blogs

August 2012

A new survey of 387 people over 18 years old reveals that three-quarters of Hongkongers read blogs weekly. So first of all, what is a blog? It's a website which contains the writer's personal experiences, observations and opinions about food, fashion, technology or any subject you can think of.

Table 1.

| Weekly Media Usage |            |             |                              |
|--------------------|------------|-------------|------------------------------|
|                    | Read blogs | Write blogs | Participate on online forums |
| Hong Kong          | 77%        | 52%         | 69%                          |
| U.S.               | 40%        | 18%         | 31%                          |

Table 2.

| What blogs do you like to read? |     |
|---------------------------------|-----|
| News                            | 59% |
| Travel                          | 54% |
| Shopping                        | 51% |
| Health                          | 41% |
| Tech/gadgets                    | 40% |

Table 3.

| What do you like to write about in your blog? |     |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----|
| Personal                                      | 55% |
| News                                          | 35% |
| Food/cooking                                  | 35% |
| Entertainment                                 | 34% |
| Travel                                        | 23% |
| Politics                                      | 11% |

Table 4.

| Do you trust blogs' advice/information? |     |
|-----------------------------------------|-----|
| All the time                            | 4%  |
| Frequently                              | 21% |
| Sometimes                               | 55% |
| Seldom                                  | 10% |
| Never                                   | 2%  |

Table 5.

| The impact blogging has on your life is...? |     |
|---------------------------------------------|-----|
| Positive                                    | 44% |
| Neutral                                     | 53% |
| Negative                                    | 3%  |

Your group wants to start a class blog and you want to persuade your class teacher to allow you to do this. You are now discussing how to convince your teacher. You may want to talk about:

- the benefits and problems with having a class blog
- which topics you want to include in your class blog
- what information from the survey you will use to persuade your teacher
- anything else you think is important

## PART B Individual Response

1. What do you read on the Internet?
2. Do you know anyone who reads blogs?
3. If you had a blog, what would you write about?
4. Do you think blogs are useful for teenagers?
5. Would you trust the advice from a blog?
6. Why do you think that some people enjoy reading other people's blogs?
7. Why do you think that some people spend so much time writing blogs?
8. How do you think blogs will change in the future?